

AI Threat Evolution Infographic

Two Parallel Timelines Showing How Technology Increases Threat Capability

Timeline 1: Evolution of AI Voice Cloning (Vishing)

From simple phone scams to highly realistic AI-generated voices.

1



Initial Vishing

1990s

Scammers posed as financial institutions over the phone to obtain sensitive information, setting the stage for later vishing tactics. [1]

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2



Automation and Spoofing

Ongoing Evolution

VoIP and caller ID spoofing made scam calls easier to automate and harder to recognize as fraudulent, expanding both reach and credibility. [2]

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3



Early AI Voice Quality

Early Development Period

Early speech-synthesis systems sounded robotic and unnatural, so fake voices were relatively easy to recognize. [3]

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4



Advanced AI Cloning

Current Era

Modern tools can reproduce a person’s voice from only 3–10 seconds of audio, preserving distinctive vocal characteristics. [4]

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5



Rapid Growth of Fraud

2022–2023

Deepfake-related fraud rose sharply, with major increases reported in the U.S., Japan, and the Philippines. [5]

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6



Future Threat

2025+

As synthetic voices capture pauses, breathing, and other human cues, real-time masking may make voice scams increasingly difficult to spot. [6]

Timeline 2: Evolution of AI-Enabled Terrorism

From online presence to AI-driven, global operations.

1



Early Digital Use

Early 2000s

Al-Qaida used websites and online forums to distribute propaganda and connect with potential recruits. [7]

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2



Social Media Expansion

Mid-2010s

ISIS used Twitter and Telegram to spread messages quickly, communicate in real time, and reach recruits at scale. [8]

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3



Encryption Technologies

2015

The San Bernardino case showed how encryption can restrict law-enforcement access to data during terrorism investigations. [9]

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4



AI-Driven Recruitment

2016

By 2016, analysts warned that AI-based sentiment analysis could help identify and target potential recruits online. [10]

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5



Deepfake Propaganda

March 2024

AI-generated propaganda videos and fabricated personas showed how deepfakes can extend and amplify extremist messaging. [11]

↓

6



Financial Evasion

Ongoing

Machine learning and advanced analytics raise concerns about how illicit financial activity could be concealed and laundered. [12]

Technology advancement → expansion, authenticity, masking, automation, and threat landscape.

Sources

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- [3] Early speech-synthesis development literature
- [4] Microsoft VALL-E / short-sample voice-cloning research
- [5] Sumsb Identity Fraud Report (2023)
- [6] FBI warnings on AI-enabled voice impersonation

- [7] UN/Europol reporting on online jihadist propaganda
- [8] Europol research on ISIS social-media and Telegram use
- [9] U.S. DOJ/FBI materials on the San Bernardino encryption case
- [10] UNICRI/UNCCT research on malicious AI use and radicalization
- [11] 2024 reporting/research on AI-generated extremist propaganda
- [12] FATF work on digitalisation, cyber-enabled fraud, and AML/CFT risk